October merges rose 49% YoY to 148 led by lpc: support per-address max-connections options on -ipcbind — Michael Ford merged 45%.

WHAT SHIPPED

lpc: support per-address max-connections options on -ipcbind (#35037); Allow non-standard scripts with -acceptnonstdtxn=1 (test net… (#29843).

REVIEW HEALTH

140 human reviewers (+8% YoY); median time-to-merge 7.8d (12-mo median 8.2d).

GOVERNANCE

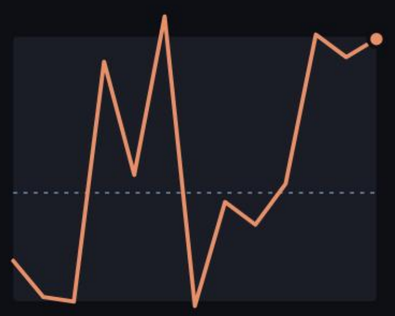
Merges by Michael Ford 45%, Reproducibility Matters 43%, Hennadii Stepanov 6%. 463 PRs open at month end, 63 older than a year.

PRs merged · bitcoin/bitcoin

148

▲ +49% YoY

vs 99 in Oct '25



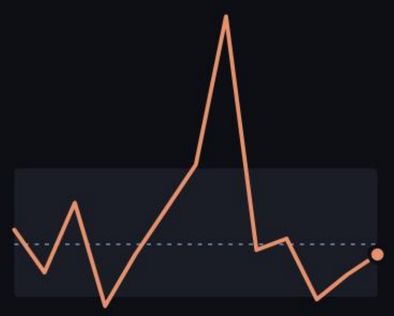
12-mo median 114 · band = p10–p90

Median time-to-merge

7.8d

▼ -12% YoY

p90: 74.5d



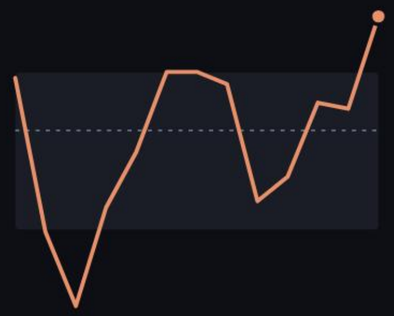
12-mo median 8.3d · band = p10–p90

Active human reviewers

140

▲ +8% YoY

vs 130 in Oct '25



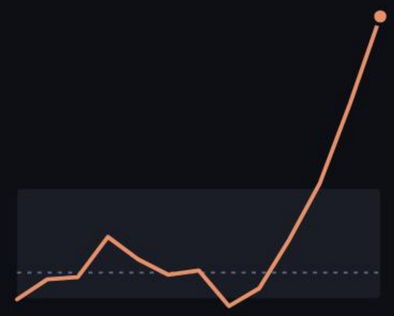
12-mo median 122 · band = p10–p90

Open PR backlog (month end)

463

▲ +38% YoY

median age 72d · 63 older than 1 yr



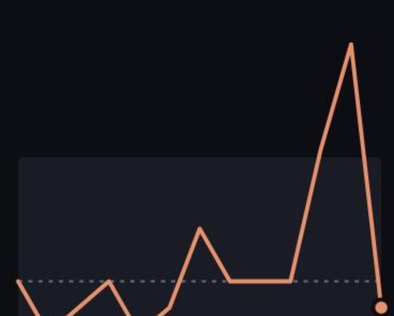
12-mo median 348 · band = p10–p90

First-time merged contributors

5

▼ -1 vs a year ago

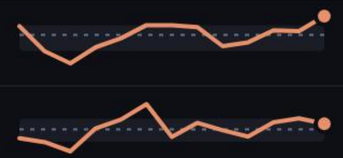
24 opened their first PR this month



12-mo median 6 · band = p10–p90

13-month development scorecard: every metric against its own trailing-12-month band

Scope: **bitcoin/bitcoin** for every row except the two labelled gui / secp256k1 merge rows.

GROUP	METRIC	OCT	MOM	YOY	12-MO MEDIAN	13-MO TREND	STATUS
THROUGHPUT	Merged PRs (bitcoin/bitcoin)	148	+2.8%	+49.5%	114		Normal
	Merged PRs (bitcoin-core/gui)	1	+1	+1	2		Normal
	Merged PRs (secp256k1 library)	14	+2	+8	8		Normal
VELOCITY	Median time-to-merge (p50)	7.8d	+0.9d	-1.1d	8.2d		Normal
	Long-tail time-to-merge (p90)	74.5d	-51.9d	-81.8d	158.4d		Low
REVIEW RIGOR	Unique human reviewers	140	+12.0%	+7.7%	122		High
	Substantive review comments	2,023	-5.8%	+20.3%	1,888		Normal
	Median unique ACKers per merged PR	2.0	-1.0	+0.0	2.0		Normal
BACKLOG	Open pull requests (month end)	463	+9.2%	+37.8%	348		High
	Open PRs older than 90 days	195	+5.4%	-12.2%	189		Normal
GOVERNANCE	Top maintainer merge share	45.3%	+3.6 pts	-12.3 pts	42.7%		Normal
	Self-merges (excl. backports & subtrees)	9	+6	-4	4		Normal

148 PRs merged; P2P & Network led product work (7%), while tests, build and maintenance were 68% of merges

MOST-REVIEWED MERGES

BY HUMAN REVIEW COMMENTS

NODE & STORAGE

#35037 ipc: support per-address max-connections options on -ipcbind

This PR enhances the Inter-Process Communication (IPC) interface by allowing users to specify a maximum number of connections for each individual IPC...

NETWORK & PRIVACY **57** review comments · **5** ACKs · by Enoch Azariah

MEMPOOL & POLICY

#29843 policy: Allow non-standard scripts with -acceptnonstdtxn=1 (test nets only)

This PR introduces a new configuration option, `-acceptnonstdtxn=1`, specifically for test networks.

NETWORK & PRIVACY **41** review comments · **3** ACKs · by Anthony Towns

CONSENSUS & VALIDATION

#34374 kernel: use struct-based logging and simplify logging interface

This PR updates the core logging system in the kernel module to use a structured format and simplifies its interface.

STRATEGIC INITIATIVES **36** review comments · **3** ACKs · by stickies-v

P2P & NETWORK

#34213 net: preserve anchors when network is disabled

This PR ensures that network anchor nodes are preserved even when the network interface is temporarily disabled, allowing for faster reconnection upo...

NETWORK & PRIVACY **33** review comments · **6** ACKs · by Bruno Garcia

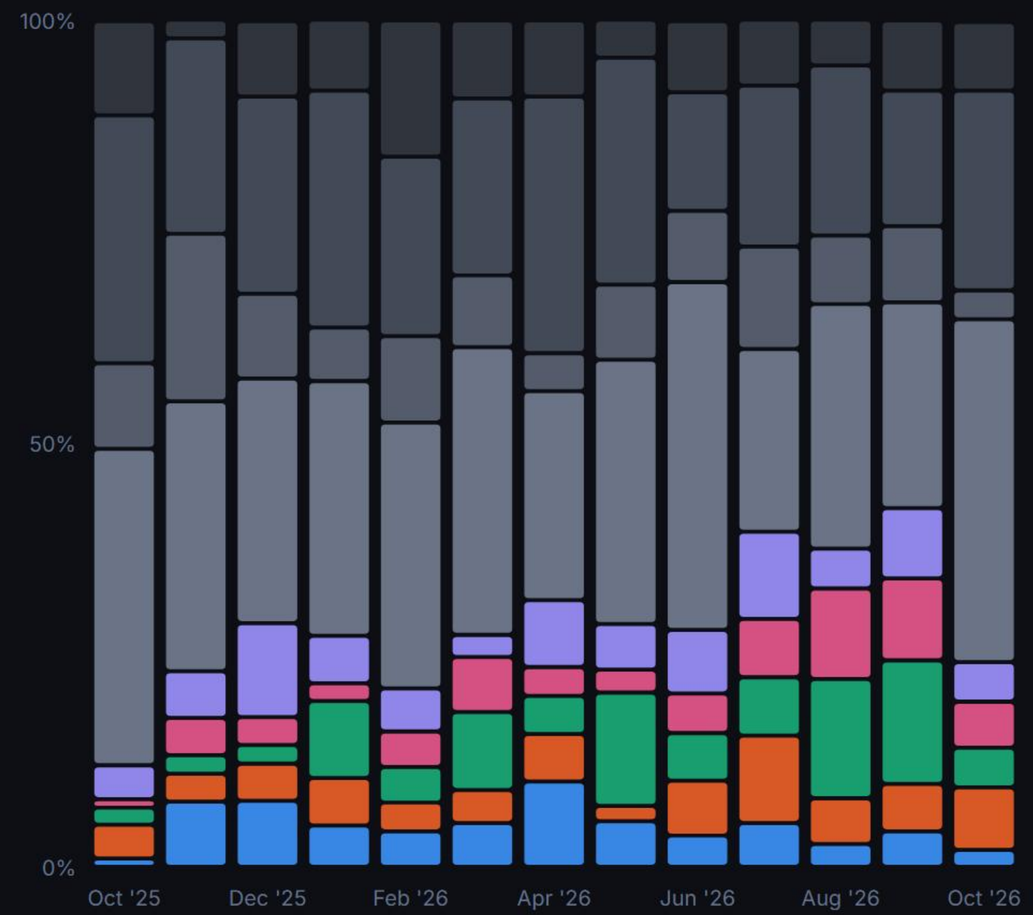
#36449 addrman: use uniform sampling inside buckets

This PR improves the address manager's peer selection logic by ensuring more uniform sampling within its buckets.

NETWORK & PRIVACY **29** review comments · **7** ACKs · by Pieter Wuille

AREA SHARE OF MERGES

13 MONTHS · % OF MERGED PRS



Bitcoin Core 32.0 is in development with 0 milestone PRs open

TRACKING ISSUES

TASK COMPLETION

Multiprocess #28722 — 83%

226/273 tasks · Russell Yanofsky · updated 2026-09-16

Erlay #30249 — 53%

9/17 tasks · Sergi Delgado Segura · updated 2026-07-29

SENDTEMPLATE #33691 — 38%

5/13 tasks · Anthony Towns · updated 2026-08-28

Mining Interface #33777 — 38%

5/13 tasks · Sjors Provoost · updated 2026-07-23

MuSig2 #31246 — 100%

14/14 tasks · Ava Chow · updated 2026-04-29

Cluster Mempool #30289 — 100%

33/33 tasks · Pieter Wuille · updated 2026-02-25

RELEASE RADAR

32.0

In development

Milestone PRs closed	131
Milestone PRs open	0
PRs in release	700

RELEASE HIGHLIGHTS

For Wallet Developers: Support for BIP 370 (PSBTv2) significantly enhances the flexibility and capabilities for constructing complex transactions, making advanced use cases more accessible.

For Node Runners: Initial block download (IBD) and block validation are significantly accelerated by fetching previous transaction outputs in parallel, leading to faster syncing for new nodes and more efficient block processing.

3 maintainers merged 95% of PRs; the top 3 reviewers wrote 25% of review comments

MERGE AUTHORITY

148 MERGES · GITHUB MERGE EVENTS

Michael Ford fanquake	67	45%
Reproducibility Matters sedited	64	43%
Hennadii Stepanov hebasto	9	6%
Ava Chow achow101	6	4%
Russell Yanofsky ryanofsky	2	1%

TOP HUMAN REVIEWERS

2,023 REVIEW COMMENTS

MarcoFalke maflcko	223	11%
Reproducibility Matters sedited	167	8%
Michael Ford fanquake	105	5%
Hennadii Stepanov hebasto	100	5%
Ferdinando M. Ametrano fametr…	89	4%
Lorinc Pap l0rinc	82	4%

Top-3 share **24.5%** · distributed review load. Bots excluded.

ONBOARDING & RETENTION

155	97	66%	24	5
active developers (authored or reviewed)	returned from last month's 147	month-over-month retention	opened their first PR	had their first PR merged

WELCOME — FIRST PR MERGED THIS MONTH

Bruce039 · amannx21 · jcastros · kravens · yashspidey

Quantum / PQC led 12-month protocol discussion; 85 threads active in October

TOPIC HEATMAP

ACTIVE THREADS PER MONTH · DELVING BITCOIN + BITCOINDEV MAILING LIST

	Nov	Dec	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	
Quantum / PQC	7	14	14	31	11	36	39	15	13	11	9	7	207
Mining / Stratum v2	7	8	4	6	4	3	2	8	15	9	4	10	80
Taproot	6	2	2	2	13	10	6	4	12	3	4	6	70
Covenants	3	8	5	12	6	12	4	1	1	3	4	3	62
UTXO & Sync	4	5	1	2		1	20	5	1	3	1	4	47
Mempool & Fees	3	6	3	10	5	6	3	5	1	3		2	47
Consensus Cleanup	1	4	9	4	2	1	4	11			1	3	40
BIP Process	19	5	5	1		1	2	2		4	1		40

MOST ACTIVE DISCUSSIONS

63 DELVING · 22 MAILING LIST

DELVING

TCP hole punching for Bitcoin nodes behind home NATs?

16 messages · 0xB10C, Anthony Towns, Jonathan Harvey-Buschel

DELVING

What does "post-quantum" actually mean for a Bitcoin L2 when settlement still happens on a

8 messages · user1, Hal_03, Adam Gibson

DELVING

Shielded Bitcoin: Private Transfers on the Bitcoin L1

7 messages · ZmnSCPxj jxPCSnmZ, ClaraShk, Adam Gibson

MAILING LIST

Lichen: L2s In CHannels ENforced on bitcoin

2 messages · waxwing/ AdamISZ, Dustin Ray

DEV MEETING HIGHLIGHTS & NEXT STEPS

4 MEETINGS

Fuzzing WG: No update provided by eugenesiegel.

QML GUI WG: johnny9dev reported integration test fixtures merged.

QA WG: brunoerg uploaded mutation testing results for `src/node/blockstorage.cpp` to mutanthub.space, highlighting interesting cases.